



"South India Vacation Tour"

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13 Nights / 14 Days

Chennai-Pondicherry-Tanjore-Trichy-Madurai-Periyar-Cochin-Allepy-Kovalam-Trivendrum

DETAILED ITINERARY

Day 01: Arrival in Chennai

You will get a warm welcome by our airport representative / Guide on your arrival at Airport; He will be assisting you for the transfer to the hotel. Dinner and overnight stay at hotel.

Day 02: Chennai

Chennai, the capital city, popularly regarded as the 'Gateway to the South' represents a culture that is distinctly different from that of northern India. After breakfast visit, Fort St. George built in 1653 during British reign in India, - now houses the Secretariat and Legislative Assembly of Tamil Nadu; St. Mary's Church, the oldest Anglican Church in India with its premises; Sri Parthasarathy Temple built by Pallavas in the 8th century AD; Kapaliswara Temple, Mylapore also an eighth century Pallava Temple dedicated to Lord Shiva; San Thomas Cathedral Basilica rebuilt in 1606 as a cathedral and in 1896 it was made a basilica. Overnight stay in the hotel.

Day 03: Chennai-Pondicherry(approx 161 kms / 03 Hrs)

Morning drive to Pondicherry enroute visiting The city of Mahabalipuram, famous for the seven pagodas. Here on the seashore is an interesting group of ancient rock temples which are the examples of Dravidian style of Architecture. Later drive to Pondicherry. On arrival check in the hotel for overnight stay.

Day 04: Pondicherry-Thanjore (approx 200 kms / 04 hrs)

Morning after breakfast visit Pondicherry city, the capital of French India before independence, Pondicherry traces its origin to Saint Agasthya, the revered sage of the south and excavations near-by reveal that a Roman settlement existed here 2000

years ago. It was the theatre of many a battle between then drive to Thanjore. On arrival check in the hotel. Later visit the temple in Thanjore

Overnight stay in the hotel.

Day 05: Thanjore-Trichy

After breakfast half day visit to Trichy (approx 50 kms / 30 minutes one way). The Rock-Fort is the landmark of Trichy. A climb of 434 steps leads to the ancient temple of Ganapati on top and a further climb to a Shiva temple. Afternoon sightseeing of Trichy. overnight stay at Hotel

Day 06: Trichy-Madurai (approx 182 kms / 05 hrs)

After breakfast at the hotel drive to Madurai, on arrival check in the hotel. Afternoon visit the famous Meenakshi Temple dedicated to the consort of Lord Shiva with its towering gopurams (rising high above the surrounding country side). Later, visit the Tirumala Nayak Palace – A gracious building in the Indo saracenic style, famous for the Stucco work on its domes , Overnight stay in the hotel.

Day 07: Madurai-Periyar (approx 170 kms / 04 hrs)

Morning drive to Periyar. The earliest sanctuary to be set up in 1934, it extends to 777 square kms & forms part of the high mountain ranges, the Western Ghats. Wild life can be seen while cruising on Periyar Lake in a motor boat. Amongst the animals which can be seen are elephants, wild boar, sambar, tiger, leopard, wild dog, langur monkeys, etc Overnight in the hotel

Day 08: Periyar-Cochin (approx 160 kms / 04 Hrs)

After breakfast drive to Cochin, on arrival check in the hotel, Overnight in the hotel

Day 09 : Cochin

Morning after breakfast city tour of the Cochin city. Cochin is the natural harbour created by the famed underwater Malabar mud-banks whose quality ensures that the rougher the seas are outside the calmer the waters are within the Harbour. Vasco-de-Gama placed it on the world map. It has a Jewish synagogue, Portuguese churches, mosques and Hindu temples. Watch the Chinese Fishing Nets. In the evening enjoy the Kathakali Dance show, Overnight stay in the hotel

Day 10: Cochin-Alleppey (approx 60 kms / 01 Hrs)

After breakfast drive to Alleppey and board the houseboat. The coastal town of Alleppey on the Arabian Sea is the Venice of the East, for the numerous canals that meander through the town. Overnight stay in the hotel.

Day 11: Alleppey-Kovalam (approx 160 kms / 3.5 Hrs)

After breakfast de-board the houseboat at Thottapally and drive to Kovalam, on arrival check in the hotel, rest of the day is free. Overnight stay in the hotel.

Day 12: Kovalam

After breakfast full day excursion to Kanyakumari enroute visiting Padmanabhapuram Palace, on arrival at Kanyakumari visit the Vivekananda Rock, the national monument dedicated to Swami Vivekananda. The memorial is built at the convergence of the Arabian Sea, Bay of Bengal and India Ocean. In the evening enjoy the lovely sunset view and return on time to the hotel for overnight stay.

Day 13: Kovalam

Day at leisure. Overnight stay in the hotel.

Day 14: Kovalam-Trivandrum airport Drop.

After breakfast transfer to Trivandrum Airport to board the flight for onward destination.

*******TOUR ENDS*******